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RAPTORS

BEEN LA PRIMA CHE SI È REALIZZATA



INTRODUCTION



THE BIRD OF PREY

The bird of prey is a group of birds of the order Accipitriformes. They are characterized by their powerful beaks, sharp talons, and keen eyesight. They are found in all parts of the world and are important predators in many ecosystems.



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RAPTORS

BORN TO PREY ON THE LOW WALK PLATERS



SCOWL
the



Adult

from areas with old buildings are sure to find this large owl.

great hunter of small mammals such as mice and gophers, but occasionally eats insects as well.

Looking markedly different from the screech owl, the barn owl possesses a light facial disk, very long legs, and very smooth feathers. It is a creamy-colored owl with brown

distinct calls have been in the species, but its shrill, even, humanlike in pitch, is the screech. This call can set a timid owl's heart pounding and leave it startled for the remainder of the

owl is the plateau's single member of the Tytonidae family of



Barn owl Photograph by John H. Heston

PELLETS

All raptors, including owls, cough up undigestible material in the form of pellets, or "castings" as they are sometimes called. Birds of prey must be able to do this because they bolt down whole animals or parts of animals. They swallow bone, fur, feathers, beaks, claws, scales, and teeth. Such material is balled up in the bird's gizzard and regurgitated.

Apparently, casting pellets serves the secondary purpose of scouring the bird's throat of residual organic matter that can breed bacteria. Raptors in captivity often sicken, and may even die, if they are fed solely on a diet of digestible meat.

Owls eject more material than do other birds of prey, partly because they are more likely to swallow animals whole, and partly because their gastric systems are less acidic



NORTHERN PYGMY OWL
Glaucidium gnomus



Adult

Habitat: The pygmy owl inhabits forests and woodlands.

Feeds: It consumes insects, and small mammals. A versatile predator, it hunts by night or

Description: This is noticeably less than the pygmy owl is a white patch on its appearance. It helps to guide approaching prey.

Voice: The pygmy owl gives a single-pitch, two-note



